

search queries as you will have to spend less time figuring out related keywords that you should use for a particular search.

7.9. Google Directory

The Google directory is an integration of Google's search technology with the Open Directory Project. The ODP, as its is called, is a vast community of volunteer editors that maintains the most thorough directory of the Web. As of this writing, the ODP has 4 million Web sites in over 590,000 categories maintained by a team of 74,719 editors. To this project, the Google Directory adds importance ranking, smarter category search, and integration with Web searches. The category search can be useful when you are unsure about what to look for and have a general idea about the topic area. To search the directory, go to directory.google.com.

Enter the search term as you would in ordinary Web search. All the search operators (see §7.1.7) that are logically consistent with directory search are valid. The valid "text" operators you can use are `allintext:`, `allintitle:`, `allinurl:`, `ext:`, `filetype:`, `intext:`, `intitle:`, and, `inurl:`

At the top of the page, a link to the related categories will take you to further categories that may be more relevant to the information you are searching for. In some cases, the category may have changed, and you will be given suggestions about alternative categories to search for information. In our example search above, we are led to the business category which contains further categories that can be drilled down into.

Thus, searching for a particular search term will guide you to a relevant categories that are related to the search term, which in turn will expand your search options as you look for parallel information.

7.10 Google Desktop Search

The latest version of Google Desktop (version 4) has taken another step in the direction of integrating your offline and online data into a single searchable repository. It was initially conceived as a software application that would bring the power of Google Web search to your computer. Over the years, Google Desktop (GD) is evolving into more than just a desktop search tool. As of this version, GD is working hard to integrate data across all your computers (home, office, laptop, etc.) enabling you to search the full text of files, pictures, and e-mail on all your computers as well as the messages in your Gmail account, the Web pages you have visited, and much, much more.

7.10.1 Installation and Preference Settings

The latest version of GD can be downloaded from desktop.google.com or desktop.google.co.in. You can also install it from our Digit archive CD with this issue. Installing the application is simple and intuitive. Once installed, GD will immediately get down to work and start indexing the files on your computer.

It will ask you for permission to index and search your Gmail messages as well as to save your Google Gadgets content and settings (see §7.10.9 for more on gadgets). Enter your Google account username and password and confirm to continue.

It will then ask you to confirm enabling or disabling of advanced features. Once you choose your preference, you will be shown the Google Desktop homepage. You can further configure other preferences by clicking on the Preferences link next to the GD homepage search box or by right-clicking on the GD system tray icon and choosing "Preferences...". This will open the Preferences page in your Web browser. The preferences are grouped into four options: Local Indexing, Google Account Features, Display, and Other.